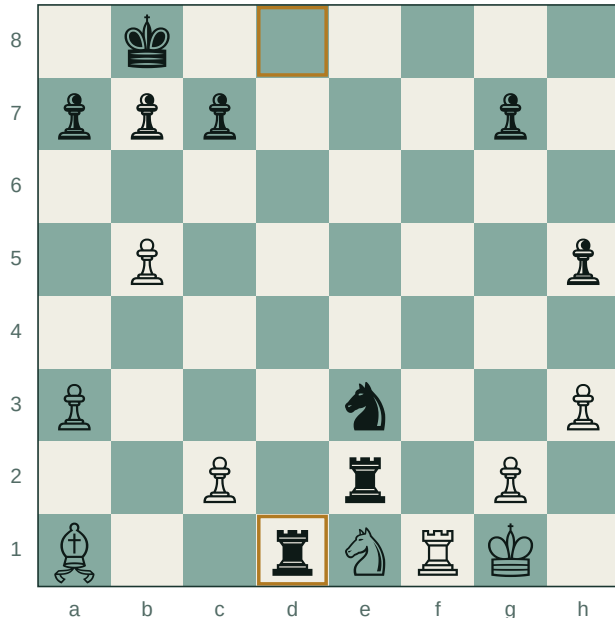


# Mate in two: White, move 32

Mate in two

White to move



Previous move: 31...Rd1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**32. Rf8+ Rd8 33. Rxd8#**

**32.Rf8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **32...Rd8**.

**33.Rxd8#** Mate: rook on d8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on b8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on d8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: rook on e2. Check for tactical protection.